

NIGERIA

FEBRUARY 2015 – JULY 2026

Prepared by Africa INSIGHTS Research Team | Vertical: Travel & Tourism

Nigeria's scenery and food strengths hold a solid perception score of 62, but worsening hospitality and a peer-group gap demand urgent service-quality action.

1,884

RECORDS IN VIEW

57%

POSITIVE

19%

NEUTRAL

24%

NEGATIVE

62/100

PERCEPTION

01 MONTH IN REVIEW

Nigeria's travel and tourism perception across the full February 2015 – July 2026 period lands at **62 out of 100**, a score that is positive but sits at the foot of a competitive peer group. The headline story is one of genuine natural and culinary appeal undermined by infrastructure deficits — electricity is the single most negative theme in the portfolio, and hospitality sentiment has deteriorated across the period. The one thing the director should act on immediately is hospitality: it is the second-most-mentioned theme in the entire dataset, its negative share is growing, and it is the gap where Nigeria trails its African peers by a reportable margin.

The long-run trajectory is encouraging: perception climbed from **40 in 2015** to a plateau in the high sixties through 2020–2023, before pulling back to **55 in 2025** and partially recovering to **61 in 2026**. That 2025 dip is the clearest risk signal in the trend data; the partial recovery suggests the market responded but has not yet consolidated. Scenery remains the dominant positive force — by far the most-mentioned theme and overwhelmingly positive — and should anchor all outward-facing brand communication.

The practical implication is a two-track strategy: defend and amplify the scenery-led brand equity that is already converting visitors, while directing operational investment and stakeholder engagement toward hospitality standards and power reliability, the two areas most capable of pulling the overall score upward in the near term.

DATA NOTE

The period label spans February 2015 to July 2026; year-level granularity means the 2026 data point covers only the months available to that point and is not a full-year figure.

DATA NOTE

The data source is overwhelmingly YouTube comments (93.2% of records), so perception reflects the audiences of travel-focused video content rather than a representative cross-section of all visitor types.

02 PERCEPTION OVERVIEW

Nigeria's **perception score of 62** on the 0–100 scale places the country comfortably above the neutral midpoint of 50, signalling a market that generates more positive than negative word-of-mouth — but one that has meaningful room to grow. The **net sentiment of 33.2** confirms a real positivity surplus, though the gap to the peer-group leader (Tanzania at 73) illustrates how much of that headroom remains unrealised.

The sentiment breakdown tells a nuanced story: **57.3% of records are positive, 18.7% neutral, and 24.0% negative**. A negative share of nearly one-in-four is the detail that should concern the director most. Markets with strong destination brands typically suppress their negative share well below 20%; Nigeria's sitting at 24.0% indicates that a meaningful minority of voices are actively discouraging potential visitors rather than simply withholding enthusiasm. The neutral block at 18.7% represents an audience that has engaged with Nigeria content without forming a strong view — a conversion opportunity if the right messages reach them.

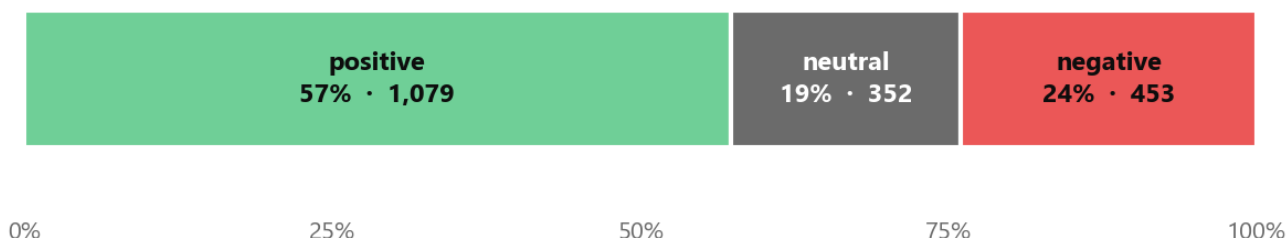
Taken together, the mix describes a destination with a loyal enthusiast base and genuine product strengths, coexisting with a vocal critical minority whose grievances cluster around infrastructure rather than the core visitor experience. That combination makes Nigeria more fixable than destinations where the product itself is weak: the improvements required are operational and policy-level, not fundamental.

DATA NOTE

Net sentiment and perception score are computed by the research team from the underlying record set; no additional arithmetic has been applied here.

Figure 1 — Sentiment breakdown

How the 1,884 records in view split across sentiment classes. Net sentiment is +33 points.



03 THEMATIC ANALYSIS

Scenery is Nigeria's defining asset and the engine of its positive perception. With **319 mentions and a net sentiment of 74.0**, it is the most-discussed and most-celebrated theme in the dataset. Its negative share remains low at **10.7%**, and volume has grown across the period — the second half of the study window records **178 scenery mentions** against **141 in the first half**, a sign that visual content about Nigeria's landscapes is gaining reach. The implication for marketing is direct: scenery-led creative is not only authentic, it is the content that the market is already amplifying. Any campaign that buries the landscape in favour of urban lifestyle imagery is working against the audience's own instincts.

Food performs strongly with a **net of 38.7** across **75 mentions**, the second-most-positive reportable theme. Nigerian cuisine is drawing genuine enthusiasm, though its negative share has crept upward across the period — **21.9% in the first half to 27.9% in the second**, a worsening of 6.0 points that qualifies as a signal worth monitoring. This may reflect inconsistency in dining experiences at scale as visitor numbers grow. Weather, with a **net of 26.1** across **23 mentions**, is modestly positive and improving, though its sample sits just above the

reporting floor and should be treated with appropriate caution.

Hospitality is the critical pressure point. It is the second-most-mentioned theme overall at **231 mentions**, meaning its trajectory matters disproportionately to the overall score. Its net sentiment of **15.2** is positive but slender, and it is worsening: the negative share rose from **32.4% in the first half to 43.2% in the second**, a deterioration of **10.8 points**. This is the single largest confirmed negative shift among reportable themes. The voices in the dataset, while not all tourism-specific, capture a recurring thread of concern about how visitors and children in transit are treated — @pvm0708, Jun 2021, reflecting on unaccompanied child travel, wrote "I would never ever let my young child travel alone," a sentiment that, even in its specific context, registers the kind of pastoral-care anxiety that attaches to destination perception more broadly.

Electricity is Nigeria's deepest structural wound in the perception data: a **net of -37.5** with **62.5% of its 16 mentions negative**. This is the most negative reportable theme by a wide margin, and the peer-group gap here is the largest of any aspect in the benchmark. Transport carries a negative net of **-2.3** but is the one infrastructure theme that is improving — negative share fell by **8.0 points** across the period, a reportable improvement that suggests infrastructure investment or operator-level improvements are beginning to register. Cost sentiment is also improving, with a **15.0-point fall in its negative share** across the period. Safety, at a **net of 2.6**, is broadly neutral and has held stable; its slight positive net across a meaningful **78-mention sample** is a more encouraging picture than international media narratives about Nigeria might lead a planner to expect.

DATA NOTE

Wildlife falls below the 15-mention threshold and is excluded from headline findings; it is noted here for completeness only.

DATA NOTE

The voices cited in the dataset originate predominantly from YouTube comment threads; their context is not always directly tourism-focused, and they should be read as indicative of broader Nigeria-associated perception rather than first-hand visitor reviews in every case.

Voices behind the numbers

The most-engaged supportive and critical mentions in this view. Emoji and non-Latin characters are stripped for print.

POSITIVE · @IndigoTraveller · Dec 2021 · 22,805 likes · score +0.28

"*Orphanage Update:* We surpassed our goal for the money raised for the orphanage plus enough to keep it running for the foreseeable future in less than 24 hours (\$80,000 USD). Orphanage building costs and materials, daily food for 50-60 children, clean drinking water, school fees etc. will now all..."

POSITIVE · @probablymedicated7358 · Jul 2021 · 6,808 likes · score +0.87

"Miss Nigeria was one hell of a special guest. She was so down to earth. The chemistry was very present. She has a good personality and great sense of humor. And celebrating her competitor in the pageant...RESPECT!!! She seems to be an amazing woman and human being. Great Video!"

NEGATIVE · @user-lj4uz2fi3d · May 2020 · 27,458 likes · score -0.80

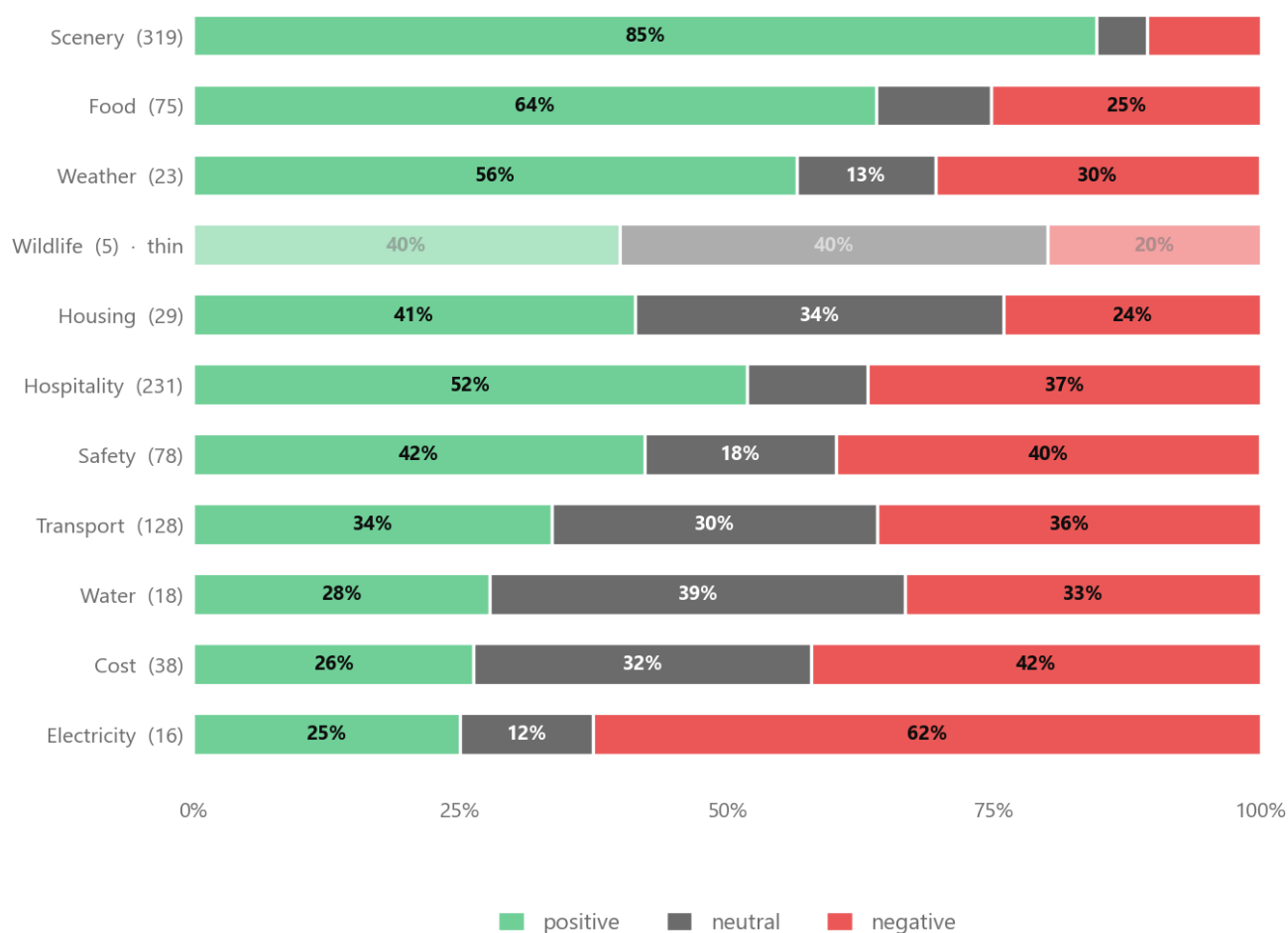
"“This 8-year-old is going to go on a plane all by herself!” **me a 19-year-old isn't even allowed to order pizza by myself**"

NEGATIVE · @pvm0708 · Jun 2021 · 14,836 likes · score -0.76

"I don't care if people think it's "overprotective" or whatever but I would never ever let my young child travel alone."

Figure 2 — Sentiment by theme

Every travel theme mentioned in this view, ranked by net sentiment. Mention counts in brackets; themes below the 15-mention floor are faded and marked thin.



04 VISITOR SEGMENTS

Segment-level data is available in the dataset but no visitor cohort — business, budget, adventure, or luxury — clears the **50-record threshold** required for comparative analysis. All four cohorts are below the reporting floor, meaning findings at the segment level cannot be ranked against one another, anchored to recommendations, or treated as representative of their respective traveller types.

Directionally, and without the weight of reportable evidence behind them, the cohort patterns are consistent with what the thematic picture would predict: experiential and natural-asset-oriented travellers appear more positively disposed toward Nigeria than commercially oriented visitors, for whom infrastructure deficits carry greater cost. These patterns merit tracking as the dataset grows, and the tourism board should consider prioritising data collection mechanisms — structured post-visit surveys, hospitality platform integrations — that would push cohort samples above the analytical threshold within the next reporting cycle.

DATA NOTE

No visitor cohort clears the 50-record threshold required for reportable comparison. All four segments (business: 39 records, budget: 30, adventure: 27, luxury: 24) are below the minimum sample size. Cohort figures are provided for future benchmarking reference only.

DATA NOTE

Only 6.4% of records were classifiable into a named segment; the remaining 93.6% are unclassified, meaning the segment distribution in this dataset should not be treated as representative of Nigeria's actual visitor mix.

VISITOR SEGMENT	RECORDS	SHARE OF VIEW	PERCEPTION	NET
Business · thin	39	2.1%	49/100	+5
Budget · thin	30	1.6%	54/100	+7
Adventure · thin	27	1.4%	65/100	+48
Luxury · thin	24	1.3%	63/100	+50

05 COMPETITIVE BENCHMARKING

Nigeria ranks **9th out of 10 reportable peer destinations** with a perception score of **62**, sitting behind Egypt (64), South Africa (65), Zimbabwe (68), Kenya (69), Senegal (70), Rwanda (70), Ghana (70), and Tanzania (73). The gap to the group leader, Tanzania, is **11 points** — a reportable and meaningful distance. Nigeria's net sentiment of **33.2** is the lowest among the reportable peer group, compared to Tanzania's 58.6 and Kenya's 52.1. Morocco, the only peer with a lower perception score, does not hold a reportable sample and cannot be compared directly. The practical message is unambiguous: Nigeria is not failing on an absolute basis, but it is losing the relative perception contest against a set of destinations competing for much of the same source-market attention.

The two aspects where the peer gap is large enough to be reportable tell a clear story about where Nigeria's competitive disadvantage is concentrated. On **electricity**, Nigeria's net of **-37.5** stands **31.0 points behind the peer average net of -6.5** — by far the widest gap in the benchmark. Every peer group member struggles with electricity to some degree, but Nigeria's struggle is dramatically more visible in the data. On **hospitality**, Nigeria's net of **15.2** trails the peer average of **25.6** by **10.4 points**, a gap that sits exactly at the reportable threshold and is compounded by the fact that hospitality is deteriorating within Nigeria's own trend. Closing the hospitality gap is the most tractable near-term competitive lever: electricity improvement requires policy timelines beyond the marketing team's control, whereas hospitality standards can be addressed through operator training, accreditation schemes, and targeted incentives.

On scenery — Nigeria's strongest theme — the peer gap is negligible and not reportable, meaning Nigeria's landscape perception is already broadly competitive with the group. This is both reassuring and clarifying: the overall score gap to peers is not driven by scenery underperformance but by the infrastructure and service themes pulling the average down. Addressing those themes would close a material share of the perception gap without requiring Nigeria to manufacture a new brand story; the story is already there in the scenery data.

DATA NOTE

Cameroon (16 records) does not clear the 50-record minimum sample and is excluded from comparative analysis.

DATA NOTE

Aspect-level peer gaps are reportable only where the gap exceeds 10 points; electricity (-31.0 points) and hospitality (-10.4 points) are the only two that qualify. All other aspect gaps are noted in the fact pack but are below the reportable threshold and are not stated as findings here.

MARKET	RECORDS	PERCEPTION	NET SENTIMENT
Tanzania	1,326	73/100	+59
Ghana	1,094	70/100	+52

Rwanda	1,526	70/100	+54
Senegal	1,114	70/100	+50
Kenya	2,075	69/100	+52
Zimbabwe	1,186	68/100	+50
South Africa	2,164	65/100	+39
Egypt	2,305	64/100	+36
Nigeria	1,884	62/100	+33
Morocco	52	39/100	-21

06 TRENDS & SIGNALS

The long-run arc of Nigeria's perception is one of substantial recovery from a weak base, followed by a worrying mid-period correction. The score began at **40 in 2015** — well below the neutral midpoint — and rose sharply to **65 in 2017** before stabilising through a high-performing corridor of **69 in 2020, 2021, and 2022**, then **68 in 2023**. The rise from 2015 to that plateau represents the most significant structural improvement in the dataset and suggests that whatever combination of content, connectivity, and sentiment-driving events occurred in that window had a durable positive effect worth understanding and replicating.

The more pressing signal is the **decline from 68 in 2023 to 55 in 2025** — a fall of 13 points in two years — accompanied by a rise in the negative share from **15.4% in 2023 to 32.4% in 2025**. This is not drift; it is a directional shift large enough to constitute a genuine reversal of the gains made since 2015. The partial recovery to **61 in 2026** with a negative share of **28.8%** is encouraging but does not yet restore the destination to its 2023 position. The 2026 period also carries the highest record volume in the dataset at **285 records**, which lends that data point comparatively high confidence.

At the thematic level, the signals divide cleanly into risks and recoveries. **Hospitality worsening by 10.8 points** is the clearest risk signal among reportable themes — it is large, it is in a high-volume theme, and it is moving in the wrong direction while the destination attempts to recover its overall score. Against that, **transport improving by 8.0 points** and **cost improving by 15.0 points** are genuine recoveries, indicating that some of the structural friction that suppressed scores in earlier years is easing. The director should treat the hospitality deterioration as the priority intervention and the transport and cost improvements as proof that operationally driven progress is possible within a reasonable time horizon.

DATA NOTE

Year-level granularity means annual scores can be influenced by the volume and nature of content published in any given year rather than reflecting a smooth population-level trend; the 2015 data point (40 records) sits below the 50-record minimum sample threshold and should be read as indicative rather than fully representative.

DATA NOTE

Housing trend improvement (-18.9 points change) and water trend worsening (21.4 points) are noted in the movement data but do not clear the reportable threshold due to thin second-half samples; they are excluded from headline trend findings.

Figure 3 — Perception over time (by year)

Perception score per period on a 0–100 scale, where 50 is neutral.

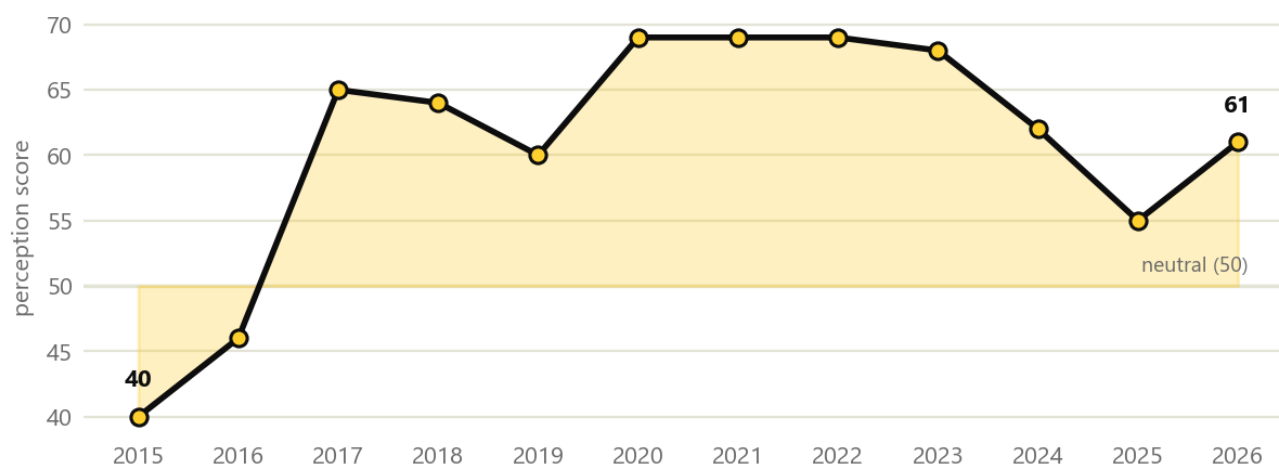
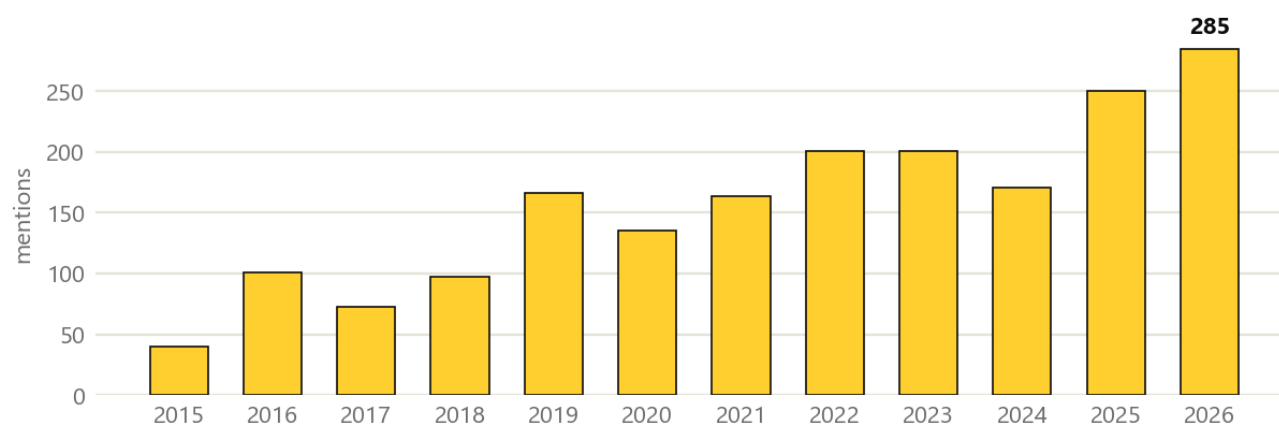


Figure 4 — Conversation volume (by year)

Records per period. Read the trend above against this: a swing on thin volume is noise.



07 RECOMMENDATIONS

The **deterioration in hospitality sentiment** — the second-most-mentioned theme, with its negative share rising 10.8 points across the period and a reportable 10.4-point gap behind the peer average — demands an immediate, structured response. The tourism board should convene Nigeria's major hotel chains, guesthouse associations, and tour operators to establish a minimum service-standard framework, tied to a visible national accreditation badge that travellers can use as a quality signal when booking. Messaging to the trade should make explicit that hospitality is the competitive variable most within operators' control and the one most directly suppressing Nigeria's peer ranking. This is not a communications fix; it requires the product to improve before the story changes.

The **electricity deficit** — a net sentiment of -37.5 and a 31.0-point gap behind peers — cannot be solved by the tourism board alone, but it can be mitigated and managed. The board should work with the hospitality sector to make power reliability a procurement criterion in destination-marketing partnerships: properties that can demonstrate reliable backup power or full-grid reliability should receive preferential placement in official promotional channels. Simultaneously, the board should engage the Ministry of Power directly with the perception data as evidence that electricity is a measurable drag on tourism revenue, providing a quantified case for prioritising tourist-zone infrastructure in the national grid improvement programme. Target audience is the board's policy counterparts in government, not the visiting public.

Nigeria's **scenery advantage** — 319 mentions, a net of 74.0, and growing volume in the second half of the period — is the brand asset that should anchor all outbound campaign investment. The board should commission a dedicated visual content programme built around Nigeria's landscapes and natural environments, designed specifically for the YouTube and video-first channels that generate 93.2% of the dataset's records. This is not about creating new perception; it is about feeding the distribution channel that is already producing Nigeria's strongest results. Partnering with established travel content creators — the format that generated the dataset's highest-engagement positive records — would accelerate reach without requiring the board to build owned-channel audiences from scratch. The creative brief should treat scenery as the lead and food as the supporting narrative, given food's strong net of 38.7 and its demonstrated ability to generate enthusiastic commentary.

The **2025 score decline** from 68 to 55 — and the partial 2026 recovery to 61 — signals that Nigeria's perception is not yet on stable footing. The board should establish a quarterly sentiment monitoring cadence rather than waiting for annual reporting, specifically tracking hospitality and safety as leading indicators. The current data architecture, weighted toward YouTube at 93.2% of records, means the board is essentially reading a video-content-audience signal; broadening data inputs to include structured visitor surveys and platform review data would improve the representativeness of the trend signal and ensure that the recovery visible in 2026 is confirmed by source diversity rather than single-channel volume.

DATA NOTE

No visitor segment recommendations can be made at the cohort level because no segment clears the 50-record reporting threshold. Segment-specific targeting should be revisited once sufficient classified records are available.

DATA NOTE

The electricity recommendation references operational and policy levers rather than communications levers because the perception gap (31.0 points behind peers) is too large and too structurally driven to be addressed through messaging alone.

08 METHODOLOGY & PROVENANCE

Country	Nigeria
Year range	2015–2026
Aspect (any of)	all aspects
Sentiment	positive, neutral, negative
Data source	all
Relevant records only	yes
Period	February 2015 – July 2026
Records	1,884
Generated	19 Aug 2026 12:30 UTC
Narrative	Written by claude-sonnet-4-6; every figure verified against the computed data.

Evidence base: 1,755 YouTube comments, 129 YouTube transcript segments. 88% of records were attributed to this market from what the text itself is about rather than from the query that surfaced them. Sentiment is scored by a multilingual transformer; themes, emotion and visitor segment are rule-based taggers. Evidence thresholds: 50 records for a reliable view, 15 mentions before a theme can headline a finding, 5 points before a theme counts as praised or criticised, 10 points before a cross-country gap is stated. Every figure in this report is computed from the filtered records by the analysis pipeline. The written analysis interprets those figures; each number it states is verified back against them before publication, and any section that fails verification is replaced by the deterministic summary.